

It Is Impossible for God to Lie

Passing in review from Hebrews 4:11, we found out that the only standard you and I can use, and not only use but trust, to differentiate between the operation of spirit and the operation of soul is the Word of God.

It is the only acceptable standard of truth that can reveal to you and me whether we are operating out of the flesh, the emotional realm, or once again that stabilizing foundation of the inner man, whose Mentor is the Holy Spirit.

This is what He is making reference to here in Hebrews 4:11 when He says, "Let us labor." The labor we should be doing is to enter into His rest. If there is anything worth contending for in a perverse and backward generation, it is the labor, the contending, to enter into His rest.

This is why He said to cast the whole of your care over onto Him so He can lavish His care on you, for your adversary the devil, as a roaring lion, walks about seeking whom he may devour. What makes you devourable is the care you cannot get rid of.

No wonder He said that if you want to know something worth laboring for, it is the rest. Evidently it is impossible to walk in this rest until you can differentiate between the operation of the stabilizing foundations of the inner man and the emotional highs and lows of the soul.

If He considered it worth laboring for, then this old boy is going to labor.

He said:

Let us labour therefore to enter into that rest, lest any man fall after the same example of unbelief.

For the word of God is quick, and powerful, and sharper than any twoedged sword, piercing even to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit, and of the joints and marrow, and is a discernor of the thoughts and intents of the heart.

Neither is there any creature that is not manifest in His sight: but all things are naked and opened unto the eyes of Him with whom we have to do.

The Word Strikes the Heart Until Soul and Spirit Stand Apart

The only qualified standard is the Word of God, which He likened once again to a two-edged sword. He said it pierces to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit.

Like any cutting edge, when you strike with it, it makes a distinction. It divides into two distinct halves. He said the Word of God has the striking power to hit and divide asunder soul and spirit distinctly, in fact, so much so that if you were to walk in between the two halves, the operation of

the soul would be on this side, and the operation of the spirit would be on this side. Based on the Word of God, you could make the distinction about which one you are operating out of.

He said this Word is a discerner of the very intents of the heart. No created thing, nothing, escapes being revealed by the Word of God. All things are stripped down and laid bare, absolutely naked, before the eyes of Him with whom we have to do.

If you will notice, the subject of this teaching is that the Word of God is the discerner of the intentions of the heart. When it strikes the blow to cause you to differentiate which one you are operating out of, He was very careful to tell you that she lays everything naked. Everything is bare before Him with whom we have to do.

He is talking about the confines and intents of the heart. He has the ability to look inside of you. There are no thoughts, intentions, or motivations, not even the tiniest little intent or motivation, that are not stripped down, naked, and laid bare before Him with whom we have to do.

So there is no use trying to fool Him. You can fool the rest of us part of the time, but you cannot fool God any of the time.

We can all sit here with our facade man, the one who has been trained religiously to sit down in services, smile at each other, and pray over dinners. But I have news for you: the only one God will fellowship with is the real man. That is the inner man.

What He is trying to tell you here is that the Word of God is quick and alive, and it will discern which one you are operating out of. So you might as well bypass the soul realm and learn how to operate out of the spiritual realm.

How does the Word of God divide this asunder? What is the great mystery of it? If the Word of God is the divider, then how does the Word come into my life to cause me to differentiate between the two?

It is not real difficult. In fact, let us look again at the process involved in putting off the old man and putting on the new. If you really want to differentiate between the two, the Word of God is the right place to go.

Go to Ephesians 4:21. I really like this.

Putting Off the Old Man Concerns Reward, Fruit, and Answered Prayer

I feel compelled by the Holy Spirit to give you a warning once again. I know you are the righteousness of God in Christ. I know you are saved. I know you are on your way to heaven by the unearnable, unmeritable grace of God.

I am not doubting the fact that you are born again. We are talking about taking off the old man and putting on the new. Going to heaven is not the issue here.

But I can tell you what is: your reward, the rest of your life, the fruit of the Spirit in your life, and whether or not you have answered prayer.

Let us look at this, because if we really want to differentiate between the flesh and the spirit, between the emotional realm of the soul and the stabilizing foundation of the inner man, here is the verse again:

If so be that ye have heard Him, and have been taught by Him, as the truth is in Jesus:
That ye put off concerning the former conversation the old man, which is corrupt according to the deceitful lusts;
And be renewed in the spirit of your mind;
And that ye put on the new man, which after God is created in righteousness and true holiness.

Is this not interesting? Do you know who He is talking to? He is talking to believers. Is it not something that He had to instruct you and me to put off the old man and his deceit, be renewed in the spirit of our mind, and put on the new, which is created after God in righteousness and true holiness?

When I was in ultra-holiness, I thought this was strange and got confused over the Word of God quite a bit. It seemed to me that He was talking to believers and telling us to put these things off and put the new on. But the standard they set for me was that if I was doing any of these other things, I was not saved.

So I was wondering how He could talk to me as if I was saved and needed to put them off if doing these things meant I was not saved.

Nevertheless, the instruction is to you and me. It is not only our instruction; it is our responsibility. He said to put off the old and put on the new.

Friday night, I really started exhorting on this part, on righteousness and the fact that you are saved anyway. But let me show you the first order of business, the foundational truth of putting off the old man and putting on the new.

He said you and I are to put lying away from us.

Lying Is the First Thing Removed Because God Cannot Build on It

Look at the twenty-fifth verse. What is the first order of business when you and I take the old man off like an old garment and put on the new, created in righteousness and true holiness?

What is the first standard, the very first thing in our lives He asks us to put away from us?

He says:

Wherefore putting away lying...

Wherefore put away what?

Lying.

If lying is the first thing He has asked us to put away, it is because lying is a foundational truth. Meaning, if the rest of your life, the life you now live, is built on a lie, then you have no foundation in God's immutability, which is His impossibility to change.

He is the same yesterday, today, and forever. He said, "I change not." It is an absolute impossibility for Him to even vary. In His immutability, it says that it is absolutely impossible for God to lie.

He never has lied. He never will lie. He never can lie. Nor can He lend Himself to any lying, to any degree or any fashion. It is absolutely impossible, from the tiniest little white lie to the deep, dark, secret lies. He cannot lend Himself to them because it is impossible for Him to lie.

If you have lying in your foundation, then the building you built on it is crumbly. I will tell you why. Because it is impossible for Him to lie, therefore He cannot lend Himself to a lie or be any part of it.

I love it, do you not?

Do you like this passing in review? In His immutability, it is absolutely impossible for Him to lie, nor can He lend Himself to a lie.

It is not that He does not want to help a person who lies, mishandles the truth, or misrepresents the truth, leading somebody to believe something that is not true. It is not that He does not want to help and bless you. He wants to. But He cannot.

You might as well think about it. I am not up here to fill all the dead space. We are up here to take an image, a mystery born in me by my Teacher, the Holy Spirit, and transplant it into you.

The mark of a good teacher is not my mannerisms from behind this pulpit. The mark of a good teacher is whether the image and understanding that was in me is transferred to you to such a degree of power that it causes change.

It is not that God does not want to help you in your sandy foundations. He wants to. But it is absolutely impossible for God to lie. If it is impossible for Him to lie, then it is impossible for Him to lend Himself to a lie or to get involved with you if your life is built on a lie.

"Well, am I saved?"

Sure, you are saved.

Let me show you something.

Refusing to Lie Is the Practical Test of Spirit Versus Soul

Go on over to Ephesians 5:13.

We are talking about the Word of God being alive and powerful to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit, able to differentiate between the two halves and let you know whether you are operating out of spirit or soul.

This is not too difficult. If you absolutely refuse to lie, exaggerate, or misrepresent the truth, my friend, you are operating out of spirit.

If you do lie, exaggerate, or misrepresent the truth, you are operating out of the soul or flesh realm.

"What if I never, never quit lying? Will I go to heaven?"

Sure. You will go to heaven. You will probably go to heaven without having a single prayer answered.

I will tell you something about God. He does not even need you to defend His reputation. He got along for a long time before you came along, and He will get along a long time if He does not come back after you and I are gone.

I have seen people go down in a flailing array of defeat, screaming and agony, calling on God. It would have been absolutely infallible proof that God was alive if He had just rescued them while they were drowning. But He just went ahead and let them drown.

I thought, "God, if You just moved in on the situation and rescued them, You would offer the world infallible proof that You exist. But You refused to, so You offered the world proof that You do not exist."

That is when I found out He did not need me to work up His defense.

If you have lies in your foundation, and it is impossible for Him to lie, and it is impossible for Him to lend Himself to you to live in your lie, then He cannot join Himself to that.

"How about my income tax?"

I will tell you about your income tax. Do not lie.

"What if it costs me everything?"

It will cost you everything the other way. It will cost you everything the other way in two realms. One is the damage to your character development. The second is that you will find out at the end of this thing that the temporary solution you caused by bending, misrepresenting, or lying about the truth will be far outweighed by the devastation at the end of the matter.

You say, "Is this edifying?"

I do not know. You tell me. You are the one who wanted to know how to operate out of the spirit.

What is operating out of the spirit?

"I am walking after the Spirit."

What does that mean? It means I am walking out of everything Jesus said I am free from and into everything He said I could be.

Then you are walking out of lying.

"But just a little white one. Pinch it a little bit, just a little."

Let me tell you something about God. The reason He said, "Blessed are the pure in heart," is because that is the man or woman who operates in the total absence of deceit. He said these people will see God, and He is not talking only about when He comes back.

You think you can temporarily solve your problem by lying? Listen, my friend, you do not know what solving a problem is until your heavenly Father shows up and whispers to it. You do not know what exhortation is until God reaches down by His power and His Spirit and pulls you up out of that thing.

He has done it many times when we prostrate ourselves and say, "Oh God, have mercy. Help me. I repent," and you mean it at the time. But after you get out of it, you start lying again.

"Sounds like you are speaking from personal experience."

Who asked you?

Purity of Heart Lets God Join Himself to Every Problem

We are talking about damage in two areas, and we will get back to that verse in a minute.

The first damage is in the impossibility for God to lie. He cannot join Himself to your problem. Therefore, you are on your own in solving it. But if He can join Himself to your problem, He said, "Blessed are the pure in heart," the man or woman who operates in a total absence of deceit, "for they shall see God."

Not just in one thing, my friend. You will see God in everything you lay your hands on. Count the price.

The second area where you will receive damage is in the development of character.

Later on in that same passage of Scripture, He says, "Do not give the devil any place."

What do you think it means to refuse to give the devil any place?

God is light, and in Him is no darkness, absolutely none at all.

"Well, I just wanted to tell a little white one. I just wanted to bend it a little."

It says in Him is no darkness at all. If you want Him to show up on the scene, let me tell you something: He is wanting to answer more prayers than you wanted to pray. It is not Him restricting Himself. It is you.

As faith people, we made some discoveries. A few men of integrity started jumping up and proving the Word, preaching the infallible, absolutely infallible Word of God, and setting the standard. They said, "It is truth. When you build your foundation on doing Jesus' sayings, it is absolute truth."

It is as constant as God's immutability is constant. He is God, and He changes not. Therefore, everything He has ever said He does not have to remit on. He has never said anything that is not truth. He changes not. His Word is truth and abides forever.

When you build your life on that unchanging truth and power that is in His Word, then everything temporary passing through time has to bow down to that which will not move.

When you build your foundation on the rock of doing His sayings, then everything temporary around you must give way to truth, which cannot change and cannot even vary.

The thing truth conforms is you and me. We do not change it. We change to it.

The faster you get even the tiniest miscoloration out of your representation of truth, the faster you are going to see God.

Faith People Must Carry the Same Truth Standard They Confess

As faith people, we have offered the Word of God as a standard. We have upheld it as truth. We have said it is infallible. God is not a man that He should lie.

We have confessed the Word over temporary situations, believing with everything in us, as much as possible where we are walking, that the eternal Word we confess over those temporary situations will change them.

Thank God for the faith people who have adopted this truth that the Word of God must change everything temporary. We got tired of being pushed around by temporary circumstances. We decided to stand up. We got tired of being pushed around by poverty. We got tired of being pushed around by disease. We decided to raise a standard to His Word.

He honored His Word above His name because it is truth. It is Him. He is truth.

How would you like your letters to be so truthful and your life to represent such truth that your name and your writings were synonymous with truth? "Thy Word is truth." That is God.

So here we are with all our faults and shortcomings. Here we are lacking that foundational truth that He said is the first order of business in putting off the old man and putting on the new: put lying, the foundational truth, away from you.

If you do not, the rest of your life will be built on lies, and He cannot get involved.

When we upheld the Word of God as the standard, we tried to understand an infallible God who could not lie. We took His Word and mixed it with impossible situations, believing that the Word we confessed over those situations would cause what was temporary to change.

But as you know, most of us faith people fell short.

I can remember turning these young faith men in Oregon onto the Word of God. Not him, but twenty or thirty others. We all jumped out experts. The one thing we did was jump in feet first.

Boy, we were the righteousness of God in Christ, born again in our human spirits. But we entered the ministry with a boatload of problems, insecurities, and intimidations. We jumped right into them and started:

"I believe that I got this. I believe that I have this. I believe I got this."

We fell to the same percentage that the rest of the faith world fell to.

I could take all you great faith people in here, line you up, and say, "What would you like to believe for in the next thirty days?"

All of you could pick something according to the Word of God, a desire of your heart, a need that qualified. Every one of you could pray the prayer of faith and begin to confess over it for the next thirty days. I think you would be disgusted with the percentage that received at the end of thirty days.

I know Lenny got disgusted. We started throwing rocks at each other, and it was not the rock of the Word either. He bad-mouthed me. I bad-mouthed him. We were a couple of kids fighting. Boy, we love each other now.

If you lined those thirty up and said, "Confess the Word over this situation," does the Word work? Yes, it does, if you do. If you work, it works. If you do not work, it does not work.

If you are not working, the Word will not change the outward circumstances as much as it will go to work on the inside of you and remove the real problem.

Here I was talking to Him about moving mountains, and He was talking to me about lying.

You say, "Were you lying?"

Better not directly.

"What did you do?"

Well, I just misrepresented the truth. Not much.

"Are you going to the meeting tonight, Brother Roberson?"

"When? I know... really, I promised to go to dinner."

Then you call:

"Ring, ring. Hey, Kenneth, remember last week when you wanted to have dinner with me? Tonight is a good night."

What did you do? I created a situation so I would not have to go. But I let the man believe I really wanted to go. I just did not want to hurt his feelings.

You mean that is miscoloration? It is enough.

Here is the problem we have with this infallible God. We are trying to understand the standard He set over His Word, because it changes not and He cannot lie. When you and I compromise, when our standards will compromise, bend, and misrepresent the truth, here we are trying to stand before an infallible God in whom it is impossible to lie, trying to use His Word over a situation.

Yet because we are willing to compromise, we are trying to judge God from our standard. We never get renewed enough on the inside because we do not have the same standard He does, and we will always judge Him according to our standard.

Until you take your stand for total absence of deceit, until you esteem the truth and the pureness of it as a foundation for your life so important that you do not care what it costs you, that it could cost your business and possibly even jail, until you esteem your word and the representation of truth to the degree that you will not bend it or vary it regardless of the consequences, you will not have the capacity to understand the standard and infallible proof that God puts on His Word.

When you arrive at that place, you will understand that standard. That revelation will be there. And, buddy, when you start confessing the standard of the Word over any situation, He said you will see God.

Do you like me?

"What if I never do that?"

You will have Christianity.

The Word Reveals What Is Disapproved and Supplies Light to Cut It Off

"Brother Roberson, you say the Word of God is the discerner of the intents of the heart?"

Yes. He knows what is going on in there.

"It divides asunder soul and spirit?"

Yes, it does.

"How does it do it, Brother Roberson?"

Very simple. This revelation I am giving you right now. You do not have to be a genius. You do not have to draw graphs on a blackboard and say, "This is the spirit, this is the soul, and this is how the Word of God differentiates between the two."

If you want to know how to operate out of spirit and not out of the emotions in the soul realm, I am telling you right now. When you adopt this standard and uphold it with everything in you, then you are going to lay the kind of foundation that a God in whom it is impossible to lie can join Himself to. I am going to promise you that at that point His final analysis and judgment on your situation will be far superior to the temporary relief you got from your lie.

Glory.

All right, look at Ephesians 5:13:

But all things that are reproved are made manifest by the light: for whatsoever doth make manifest is light.

Reproved is exactly the opposite of approved. All things that are disapproved, such as lying, cheating, stealing, and the lusts of the flesh, are made manifest, or revealed, by the light.

Wherefore He saith, Awake thou that sleepest, and arise from the dead, and Christ shall give thee light.

Verses 13 and 14 are one thought. They were never meant to be separated. He says all things that are reproved, such as lying, cheating, stealing, and lusts of the flesh, are made manifest by the light.

That is what He was talking about in Hebrews. He said the Word of God is quick, dividing asunder spirit and soul, and is a discernor of the very intents of the heart. Everything is naked, stripped down, and bare before the eyes of Him with whom we have to do. The subject was the intents of the heart.

When we preach the Word of God, it peels everything away from you that is not spirit. It strips it down naked and puts it in front of you so you can make a decision whether you want to operate in it or not.

If it is not, do not ever run around and say the Word does not work. Do not ever run around and say my Father does not answer your prayers.

He says all things that are disapproved are made manifest. They are revealed by that light. Whatsoever makes manifest is light.

Wherefore, or therefore, because of what I have just said, He says to the believer, "Awake thou that sleepest, and arise from the dead, and Christ shall give thee light."

Do you realize He is talking about the believer?

He says, "Look, you have received the Word of God, a discernor of the intents of the heart, and every created thing is laid naked before it, including the intentions of your heart. Wherefore, you that sleep, because you have the Word and you have those things that are not approved made

manifest by the light, and not only does He reveal them, but He supplies the power to cut them off, arise."

He says, "You that sleep, you that look just like the world, come on. Arise from the dead, and He will give you light."

Do you want to walk and talk in infallible fellowship with a sovereign, righteous, judging, immutable, eternal-life, love, omniscient, omnipotent, omnipresent God?

Then He says, "Arise. You that are asleep, come on. Arise from the dead, and He will give you light."

You want help? Do you think you are solving anything by throwing sand into your foundation and exaggerating the truth? You are not.

This is what He said in Mark 4, when He said:

And these are they which are sown on good ground; such as hear the word, and receive it, and bring forth fruit, some thirtyfold, some sixty, and some an hundred.

Then He makes an incredible statement in the next verse:

Is a candle brought to be put under a bushel, or under a bed? and not to be set on a candlestick?

Is the Word of God given to you not to understand? Is the Word of God given to you not to illuminate?

Then He says:

For there is nothing hid, which shall not be manifested; neither was any thing kept secret, but that it should come abroad.

He is saying, this is good ground. The good ground is the one who will light the candle, the revelation knowledge of the Word, and it shines a brilliant light on all the obstacles that have been disapproved or reproofed in your life so that you can purge these things out of you, such as lying.

He will give you light. He said, "You that sleep, that look like the world, rise from the dead. Get out of it, and My Father will come on the scene and give you light."

Righteous Anger Fortifies Truth, but Malice Defends a False Life

Let us go back over to Ephesians 4 and wind this up.

That ye put off concerning the former conversation the old man, which is corrupt according to the deceitful lusts;
And be renewed in the spirit of your mind;
And that ye put on the new man, which after God is created in righteousness and true holiness.

Boy, I like that.

Wherefore putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbour: for we are members one of another.
Be ye angry, and sin not: let not the sun go down upon your wrath:
Neither give place to the devil.
Let him that stole steal no more: but rather let him labour, working with his hands the thing which is good, that he may have to give to him that needeth.

Notice when He says, "Be angry, and sin not," and where the devil gets in, which He said is giving him place.

He said, "Go ahead. You can be angry, but do not sin. Do not let the sun go down on your wrath."

When would getting angry not be sin? Have you ever heard of righteous indignation?

"Are you threatening me? You want me to bend the truth? You want me to lie? I will not lie."

That anger rises up on the inside and fortifies your stand of truth. Have you ever noticed that?

That is the kind of anger that sins not. It is not self-righteousness. This kind is coupled with love.

Be angry and sin not. In other words, sometimes there is a rush of adrenaline that offers the fortitude and strength you need to make the decision when it needs to be made.

But when a person gets angry and goes to bed on the anger, it is because he is full of malice, strife, and unforgiveness. If you are protecting a life that is full of lies, then you have to defend something you are not.

He said, "Do not give place to the devil."

The reason He destroyed lying as foundational truth also is this: when a person lies, the lying is not the surface thing. Lying is nothing more than a fruit of a much, much more serious problem.

He said that kind of problem is one of those things that is disapproved. Sometimes it lies deep in the dark places of a man's character. He said the only thing that can differentiate and discern is that light. He will reveal it and cut it off if you will let Him.

He said, "Do not give place to the devil."

Why do you want to give the devil authority in your life? The opposite of truth is lie. Do you want to know where all lies come from? I can tell you where all truth comes from.

I do not care if I put an insignificant little stick pin here and you accidentally sit down on it and are going to fire me.

"Was it you?"

"Yes, I put it there."

I do not care if you are going to sue me for ten billion dollars, and all I would have to do is lie and say, "I did not put it there. It was not me." All I would have to do to save my neck and save myself from incredible amounts of trouble is bend it a little.

I will not do it anymore.

The reason I will not is because I do not only want to experience believing God with the standards He has set, removing my lack of capacity to understand Him in the realms of truth. I will resist. I do not care how teeny and insignificant it seems. I am not going to give the devil a camping place in my character.

The reason He mentioned anger is that anger is a fruit of lies. If a man will not be healed from lying, then neither can he get over anger and hatred.

If you have a longstanding problem with anger, you fly off the handle, you get mad, and you cannot seem to control it, and it takes you days to get over it, my friend, usually a root cause is somewhere in there. You are not representing the truth, and you have given the devil a campground in yourself.

All right. The Word of God just leaves you naked.

Working With Your Hands Rejects Schemes That Twist the Truth for Gain

He said:

Let him that stole steal no more: but rather let him labour, working with his hands the thing which is good, that he may have to give to him that needeth.

What kind of verse is that to stick in there? What if the guy is a doctor? The kind of work He is talking about with his hands is work. What if the guy is a doctor or something and does not dig ditches?

He says, "Let him that stole steal no more." He is talking to believers. He is giving believers instruction on taking off the old man and putting on the new.

Do you know that if a guy will lie, he will steal? Mine are innocent.

Now, you stole something.

He said, "Let him that stole steal no more." He is talking to believers about taking off the old man and putting on the new. If this is the case, He is not talking about some armed robber, some guy running around holding up QuikTrips. He did not write this letter to him. He is writing it to believers.

So when He says, "Let him that stole steal no more," what He is saying is this: if you can work, if you are capable of it, and work is available, and you do not work, then you are stealing from the person you are living off of.

I thought you wanted to walk in the Spirit.

In closing, the fact that He put an emphasis on the hands part, even though He was writing to every variety of believer, professional or ditch digger, did not matter, tells us something.

The reason He put the emphasis on the hands is because there are a lot of people, just like there are now, running scam games, conniving, scheming, twisting the truth, pushing quick-profit deals, and preying on sheep, using God and prosperity as a basis to motivate their lusts and their flesh to get in on a deal.

So He said, "Look, why do you not quit stealing from the sheep, go on and be honest, get a job, and work with your hands?"